2022-23

1. Five experiences I enjoyed

▼ traveling around the world and seeing new things (nature, culture, food, way of life)

- I can’t explicitly explain how seeing many different things has changed me, but I know it did. I feel like a different person.
- Having local friends also made me feel more like a citizen of the world.
- Travelling and flying a lot within the US taught me efficient ways of packing, flying, traveling, and booking stuff.

▼ routine (e.g. coffee-workout-shower-breakfast, workout-shower-dinner-drinks)

- Because I can optimize my schedule and activities—and I love efficiency and productivity.

▼ long deep conversation with interesting people

- This energizes me more than going to a large loud party.
- I love the mental stimulating discussion and reflection.

▼ learning new things, especially those I find useful and interesting

    - Knowing that investing my time into something useful makes me think it's worth it. And so, I put more attention, focus, and effort.

▼ meeting/studying/working with smart and reflective people

    - Makes me competitive and brings the best out of me.

2. Five things I learned

▼ about myself (self-awareness)

    - how resilient, flexible, and adapative I am
    - that I need to be more empathetic (nicer, kinder, graceful, listen more)
    - see my wants and desires in a new light
    - strenths and weaknesses
        - world-class quantitative skills
        - attention to details (visually)
        - so many weaknesses (some worth it to improve, most not)
    - bad habits
        - being overwhelmed faster than I should be
        - fidgety: be smoother and more gentle and graceful, like a freshly cut butter

- how behind Philippines is in so many ways, including my previous self

▼ iteration is faster and produces better results than being perfectionist

    - Just do it in the beginning, ignore the quality, let the idea flow. Then polish through iteration.

▼ growth happens when there is pain, and you reflect to extract the lesson from the pain

- it's okay and more efficient to ask for help

▼ one person you meet, even briefly, can change your life

    - So don't plan too far ahead in the future.

    - Embrace the uncertainty, plan for and adapt to uncertainty.
    - Make decisions quickly with the available information, and adjust as more information come in.

▼ MBA stuff

    - Organizational behavior
    - Finance
    - Strategy

- Business Empire is all about movement.
    - Rails move goods, then move oil or energy. Plane moves people. Internet moves data. Stripe moves money. Uber moves people. Amazon moves goods. What's next?

▼ there's no right or wrong answer, real world operates in countless shades of gray

    - It's about being consistent with your values and living the risks and consequences of your decisions.

▼ in the end, it's all about family and relationships and experiences and faith

    - This will give you the most happiness and fulfillment in life.

▼ awareness of life

    - My life in the Philippines felt like living in the darkness. Going through HBS with super smart people and living in the US for 2 years exposed me to higher level of living, being, and mental consciousness—it's like waking up from a long and deep sleep. This experience changed the way I see myself, life in general, career and business, society, and the world. HBS opened my mind to more colorful and accessible world with countless possibilities.

3. Habits to maintain

▼ being myself (polite, kind, humble, quite, nice, smile face)

    - Don't ever change to fit in to a group. Be yourself and you'll see your people who are worth it to be friends with.

- ▼ learning new things and huner for self improvement
  - Always energizes me.
- ▼ being curious and open-minded
  - Accept that there are a lot of things you don't know that could be better than what you have been used to. And you won't learn them and take advantage of them if you won't let them in to your mind.
- ▼ never ever ever give up
  - Never.
- ▼ contact with old good friends

4. Remembering this year by

- ▼ first time living through winter
  - Winter is actually fun, it's the darkness that made me feel sad from time to time.
  - I also found out I prefer winter to very hot humid summer.
- ▼ Colombia, Israel, Iceland, Canada, Mexico, all around the US
  - So many travels, so many memories.
- ▼ Stripe internship (first job in the US)
  - I tried to do my best and was able to impress my colleagues and manager.
  - This boosted my confidence so much, knowing that I can compete and excel in a very fast pace and highly competitive environment.
  - I felt the confidence when I came back to HBS for my EC year.
- ▼ living in San Francisco
  - SF is a nice vibrant city during the day, but dead during the evening.
  - Made me realize SF or west coast is not for me.
- ▼ HBS EC year
  - Different people in classes.

    - More interesting classes.
    - Much much more relaxed than RC year, more socials and rest, less pressure.
    - I see who my real friends are and I was more intentional with where I spend my time on.
    - I realized how many friends I've made in RC year when I came back for EC.

▼ Boracay with family

    - Relaxing trip, good bonding with family.

5. Proud achievements

- balancing learning, health, and socials at HBS

▼ making good friends with very different background at HBS

    - It's way easier to connect with Asian and LatAm people that Americans (and some Europeans).
    - But, with dudes, I just connect. Works like magic.

- graduating at HBS without financial assistance from parents or anyone
- being the only MBA hire of Stripe in 2023

6. Biggest disappointments

- not bold enough with my comments in classes
- lack of courage and confidence, sometimes
- losing interest in something immediately because of petty reasons that I entertained, only to realize that I'm missing out a lot by not putting my heart into my actions

7. Insecurities

- not eloquent enough
- not working for prestigious companies or going to elite college before HBS

8. Best decisions

- pushing harder when things get tougher
- saying ‘no’ to many things and prioritizing what I really want
- not aiming to be a Baker Scholar and focusing more on learning and experience

9. How did POV of world change

- world looks bigger and more colorful, but also smaller and more connected at the same time
- understands better how world works economically and socially
- there’s so much beautiful things in this world to see and learn
- the world is a messy brutal unfair world
- there are very few people who understand the world both from the top and from the bottom
- nobody care much about you, everyone is focused on their own goals and desires
- the world is so much smaller for rich people
- it’s so easy to go around from a developed country to anywhere

10. What I’m glad I did:

▼ breaking up with Thea

  - Although we love and care for each other very much, our personalities and life trajectories are diverging. It’s heart braking but this is the best for the both of us. Eventually, I feel more free to reach my full potential. I’m sure she’s also more free, and I hope she finds her right person who deservers her big heart and all of her great qualities.

- continued fighting even it felt too hard, never gave up

▼ defering for a year at HBS

  - It would be a totally different experience and reflections I wrote above if my RC year was online.

▼ putting myself out there (getting out of my comfort zone)

- some turned to friendships and great experiences, some turned to awkward moments, bad experiences, and waste of time—nevertheless, net positive.